

ware that can operate on Torrents, but BitComet is one of the oldest and the best.

The interface is similar to the other P2P software, but with reduced functionality. Torrents also have their own set of dedicated Web sites, but that may require registration with some. So for special-interest group users, this is a fine option.

With BitComet's three-pane interface, you get a list of Web sites that host the file you wish you download. All file formats are supported, and filenames are informative enough to let you make a decision whether something is your desired file. Once you decide what file you want to download, double-clicking on it would download it to your desktop (or a pre-defined folder) from where you have to drag and drop it into BitComet. It then searches for how many sources are available for the file, and the time taken for this can vary depending on the availability of the file.

For example, an MP3 of a top song would take less time than, say, a video clip of BBC's clickonline. This version of BitComet comes with chat capabilities, stats trackers, and the ability to bookmark your favourite sites.

Going by the current trend and its increasing popularity, BitComet is a very good alternative to your usual P2P file sharing.

LimeWire 4.9

LimeWire took over the reins from Napster when the latter was forced to shut down by US Federal agencies. It uses the Gnutella engine, which is one of the oldest for P2P filesharing.

LimeWire hasn't been behind in the trend of updating its interface. The new interface is neat and simple, with most of the functionalities accessible from the main window. However, the new Java-based interface can be a bit slow to load at first. The improvement is not only on the surface; the new search query gives better results than previous versions.